GALTech
School of Technology Pvt. Ltd.

Free Reel Effects Installation & User Guide

Add 11 Instagram-style effects to any vertical video. Free, no After Effects, everything runs on your own computer.

Created by **GALTech School of Technology**
www.galtechlearning.com

GitHub: github.com/seokochin/galtech-video-effects-skill

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1. What is Free Reel Effects?

Free Reel Effects is a **Claude skill** and a Python tool. It turns a vertical (9:16) talking-head clip into a fast-paced reel with up to 11 effects. A free, open-source AI model (u2net_human_seg) cuts the person out of every frame. That is what makes effects such as **text behind the person** and **spotlight** possible.

There are no paid APIs and no credits. The only cost is your computer's processing time.

#	Effect name	What it looks like
1	glass	Frosted-glass cards float in: title card, live audio bars driven by the real audio, a stat counter
2	orbit	Mini preview cards of the other effects circle around the person (back cards go behind them)
3	spot	The room goes dark, the person stays lit
4	behind	A huge glowing word placed behind the person's head
5	title	Yellow background with a big "10 EDITS" style title
6	todo	Dark "Editing your clip" checklist ticking off items one by one
7	news	Newspaper front page with masthead, highlighted headline and the video inset
8	brief	Orange magazine-poster layout with two video tiles and a bold headline
9	timeline	Editing-timeline panel (clips, captions, grade, waveform, render bar) above the video
10	toggles	iPhone-style switches flip on one by one
11	match	The video dissolves into orange halftone dots and back (transition)

2. What you need

Item	Details
Computer	Mac (Intel or Apple Silicon), Windows 10/11, or Linux. A 4-core laptop is enough.
Python	Version 3.9 or newer. The installer checks this and installs it if missing (except on Windows without winget).
ffmpeg	Free video tool. The installer installs it automatically.
git	To download the skill. Or use the "Download ZIP" button on GitHub instead.
curl	Downloads the AI model. Built into Mac, Linux and Windows 10+.
Disk space	About 500 MB: ~180 MB for the AI model and fonts, plus the Python packages.
Internet	Needed once, during install. After that everything runs offline.
Your video	Vertical 9:16 MP4 with one person, framed waist-up. Any length; 30–90 seconds is ideal.

3. Install on Mac

Step 1 · Open Terminal. Press **Cmd + Space**, type **Terminal** and press Enter.

Step 2 · Download the skill. Copy and paste this, then press Enter:

```
git clone https://github.com/seokochin/galtech-video-effects-skill.git
cd galtech-video-effects-skill
```

> If your Mac asks to install the **Command Line Developer Tools** when you run git, click **Install**, wait for it to finish, then run the command again.

Step 3 · Run the installer:

```
bash install.sh
```

It checks Python, ffmpeg and curl, and installs anything missing using Homebrew. If Homebrew is not on your Mac, it installs Homebrew first and may ask for your Mac password. Then it installs the Python packages and downloads the AI model and fonts.

Step 4 · Wait for "All set!". That line means the skill is ready. The first install usually takes 2–10 minutes, depending on your internet speed.

4. Install on Windows

Step 1 · Open PowerShell. Click Start, type **PowerShell** and open **Windows PowerShell**.

Step 2 · Install git (only if you don't have it):

```
winget install -e --id Git.Git
```

Close PowerShell and open it again after installing git. No git? You can also open the GitHub page, click **Code → Download ZIP**, unzip it, and open PowerShell in that folder.

Step 3 · Download the skill:

```
git clone https://github.com/seokochin/galtech-video-effects-skill.git
cd galtech-video-effects-skill
```

Step 4 · Run the installer:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File install.ps1
```

It installs Python 3.12 and ffmpeg with winget if they are missing, then the Python packages, the AI model and the fonts.

> If it says **ffmpeg not found** right after installing ffmpeg, close PowerShell, open a new window, go back to the folder and run the installer again. Windows only picks up newly installed tools in a new window.

On Windows, type **python** instead of **python3** in the commands in this guide.

5. Install on Linux

Works on Ubuntu/Debian (apt), Fedora (dnf) and Arch (pacman). Open a terminal and run:

```
git clone https://github.com/seokochin/galtech-video-effects-skill.git
cd galtech-video-effects-skill
bash install.sh
```

It may ask for your password (sudo) to install missing system packages such as ffmpeg or python3-pip.

6. What the installer does

Stage	What happens
1. System tools	Checks python3, ffmpeg and curl. Installs missing ones (Homebrew / apt / dnf / pacman / winget). Confirms Python is 3.9+.
2. Python packages	Installs numpy, opencv-python-headless, pillow and onnxruntime. Skips this if they are already installed.
3. AI model + fonts	Downloads the free u2net_human_seg model (~176 MB) and the Montserrat and Playfair Display fonts into ~/.free_reel_fx.
4. Final check	Confirms the packages import and that the model and fonts are in place, then prints "All set!".

You can run the installer again any time. It only installs what is missing.

7. Manual install (if you prefer)

1. Install Python 3.9+ and ffmpeg:

```
# Mac
brew install python ffmpeg
# Windows
winget install Python.Python.3.12 Gyan.FFmpeg
# Ubuntu / Debian
sudo apt install python3 python3-pip ffmpeg curl git
```

2. Install the Python packages:

```
python3 -m pip install numpy opencv-python-headless pillow onnxruntime
```

If pip says externally-managed-environment, add **--user** (or **--user --break-system-packages**).

3. Download the model and fonts:

```
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py setup
```

8. Add the skill to Claude

Once the skill is in Claude, you don't have to remember any commands. Claude asks for your on-screen texts, runs every stage and checks the result for you.

- Zip the **free-reel-effects** folder (it contains SKILL.md and fx.py). On Mac: right-click the folder → **Compress**. On Windows: right-click → **Send to → Compressed (zipped) folder**.
- In the Claude app, open your **Skills** settings and upload the zip.
- Start a chat (Claude Cowork works well because it can reach files on your computer) and say: "Add reel effects to my video", then share your video.

> The installer must have run on the computer where the effects are rendered, so Python, ffmpeg and the AI model are available. On a new computer, Claude follows the skill's first step and checks this for you.

9. Make your first reel

From inside the **galtech-video-effects-skill** folder, put your video there (for example **my_clip.mp4**) and run:

```
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py all --input my_clip.mp4 --output my_reel.mp4 \
  --title "My Shop" --subtitle "New arrivals" --word SALE \
  --brand "The Shop Daily" --headline "This week only: 20% off every phone" \
  --highlight "20%" --toggles "Free delivery,Cash on delivery,7-day returns"
```

This runs all the stages in one go. To control each stage, run them one by one (each can be stopped and resumed):

```
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py prep   --input my_clip.mp4 --work work
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py masks  --work work
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py plan   --work work
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py render --work work [text options]
python3 free-reel-effects/fx.py concat --work work --output my_reel.mp4
```

Stage	What it does
prep	Crops your video to 720×1280 at 25 fps and keeps the audio
masks	Cuts the person out of every frame (the slow part, about 0.5 s per frame)
plan	Shows which effect appears at which second
render	Draws the effects. Use --from / --to frame numbers to render in parts
concat	Joins the parts and adds your original audio back

10. All options

Option	Used by	Example / default
--effects	all	glass,spot,behind,news (default: all 11 in order)
--intro / --outro	timing	Clean seconds at start / end. Default 0 and 3
--kicker, --title, --subtitle	glass	"NOW PLAYING", "My Video", "Edited with AI"
--stat, --stat-value	glass	"Views", "12.4K" (placeholder: use real numbers)
--word	behind, timeline	3–6 letters look best, e.g. SALE
--count, --unit	title, brief	"10" + "EDITS"
--brand, --headline, --highlight, --dek	news	Newspaper name, headline, one highlighted word, sub-line
--toggles	toggles	Exactly 3 labels, comma-separated
--from, --to	render	Frame range for rendering in parts
--seconds	masks	Stop after N seconds; run again to continue

11. Tips for best results

- Film one person, framed waist-up, with the head in the top third of the frame.
- Each effect needs about 3.5 seconds to play fully. For clips under 40 seconds, choose 4–6 effects with **--effects**.
- Keep on-screen texts short. A single highlighted word in the headline looks best.
- On-screen text uses English (Latin) fonts. For Malayalam or Arabic text, download a matching Noto font and swap it into the **font()** function in fx.py.

- The "Views" stat card is a placeholder. Put a real number in it, or drop the glass effect, before posting.
- Check a still from the middle of each effect before posting: **ffmpeg -ss 12 -i my_reel.mp4 -frames:v 1 check.jpg**

12. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
git: command not found	Mac: run xcode-select --install. Windows: winget install -e --id Git.Git, then reopen PowerShell. Or use Download ZIP on GitHub.
ffmpeg not found (Windows)	Close and reopen PowerShell after the installer adds ffmpeg, then run install.ps1 again.
externally-managed-environment (pip)	The installer retries with --user automatically. Manually: add --user --break-system-packages.
Download failed during setup	Check your internet connection and run the installer (or fx.py setup) again. It resumes.
Masks stage is slow	Normal: about 0.5 s per frame on a 4-core laptop. Use --seconds 160 and run masks again to continue in parts.
Text behind the person is cut off	Use a shorter --word (3–6 letters works best).
Effect looks cut short	The clip is too short for all 11 effects. Pick fewer with --effects.
Boxes instead of letters	The text uses a script the font doesn't cover (e.g. Malayalam). Swap in a Noto font.
Changed texts but video looks the same	Delete the old seg_*.mp4 files in the work folder before rendering again.

13. Update or uninstall

Update to the latest version, from inside the folder:

```
git pull
```

Uninstall: delete the **galtech-video-effects-skill** folder and the model cache:

```
rm -rf ~/.free_reel_fx        # Mac / Linux
Remove-Item -Recurse $HOME\.free_reel_fx   # Windows
```

14. Learn Claude with GALTech

Want to build skills like this yourself, and automate your everyday work with Claude? Join GALTech's **Claude AI Generalist Course**.

Course detail	
Duration	3 weeks · 15 live lectures
Language	Malayalam
Mode	Live online (Kerala, UAE and GCC) + offline at Koratty, Thrissur
Coding needed?	No: beginner friendly, hands-on and project-based
You learn	Projects, Artifacts, Memory & Styles; prompt engineering; automating desktop, browser, Excel and Office tasks with Cowork, Skills and scheduled tasks; Claude Design; research with Claude; an AI governance playbook
Certificate	NACTET-affiliated certificate
Who it's for	Working professionals, business owners, operations teams, students in the UAE and GCC

Course page and Apply Now:
www.galtechlearning.com/courses/claude-course-ai-generalist

Free Malayalam lessons on Claude and AI tools: YouTube: GALTech Learning Hub.

15. Contact GALTech

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This skill on GitHub	github.com/seokochin/galtech-video-effects-skill

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